



“The premise that HTML5 will eventually replace Flash to me is a myth. We’re comparing what Flash already did some time back to what HTML5 is only promising to do.”

— Himanshu Mody
CEO Tekno Point Multimedia

The HTML5 debate

Reams have been written about this subject and everyone is waiting with bated breath to see the outcome. If indeed HTML5 will let you do many of the things Flash can, it’s not a stretch of imagination to think of the eventual questions – Will Flash be phased out? Will Flash developers be left redundant? If so, can they transition to the new standard? – The industry opinion seems to be unanimously similar. “It is a step in the right direction. HTML 4 didn’t support a lot of functions, you had a lot of add on components being done like XML, XHTML, XForms etc. So HTML5 is a right step towards taking everything back into the standard hyper text model. Having said that it is still evolving,” said Sandeep. It is still an evolving technology standard. Besides, each of these tools are meant for different things. So in the future you’ll see a proper position for each of these. It’s more likely to work in conjunction.

“Take for instance YouTube - They’ve come out with HTML5 videos, but they’re yet to completely move to it.

Events in the past few years have led to a gradual shift towards HTML5 being adopted on a much larger scale and we’ll go into some of these incidents. The first would be when Steve Jobs wrote an entire blog post criticising the implementation of flash and subsequently had gotten flash support removed from iOS which at that time had the dominant share of tablets and smartphone sales. Even the Redmont Giant has consciously decided against supporting Flash in the Windows Phone environment and initially on the WindowsRT operating system which is what they’ve got on their ARM based tablets. Earlier this year, they decided on adding flash support